

5 Let's say, for example, there is a person who, no matter how you look at him, has no good or desirable qualities. But then someone comes along and falls in love with this bad person and thinks, "Maybe I can help this person if I am with him or her." In the beginning, this second person is not as difficult, intolerable or crazy as the person he or she has fallen in love with. But eventually the second person will become unhappy and unstable as a result of being with the difficult person. The first person could be an alcoholic and not trying or committing him or herself to sobriety. Then a woman or a man comes along who thinks she or he can help this person stop drinking if they are together. But too often this does not work. In Buddhism, as I've explained before, there are Ten Worlds.⁹ Each individual has these Ten Worlds. But this system also exists within interrelationships between a husband and wife, parent and child, brother and sister, lovers, etc. That is, the Ten Worlds also exist within the relationships with other human beings. Society also has the Ten Worlds. Therefore, if each individual that you deal with has the Ten Worlds, then the point is to accept not just the aspects of the person's character which you like, but to accept all of the Ten Worlds within each individual.

B2: If a person who is a Buddhist chants, realizes and accepts that mistakes were made, and has apologized for this over a lifetime, but the situation keeps repeating, and the behavior continues, the person may think that chanting doesn't work because the understanding is that if you just chant it will go away or the situation that triggers that behavior or trait will no longer occur. What do you think about that? RH: If a person says again and again, I'm sorry, I'm sorry, I'm sorry, by making that kind of apology the person is committing another bad action. Sange is the starting point – to apologize and confess. The next step is introspection and self-reflection. If you don't reflect on yourself and your own behavior then the bad behavior continues, and it will seem as though chanting does not work because your apologies are just empty words. But as Buddhists, you should have a clear mind about what you are doing. Be more critical and reflective of yourself, questioning your own behavior before you criticize the behavior of others. You should, in fact, be a little easier on others, realizing that they too have the Ten Worlds. This is what Nichiren Daishonin¹⁰ taught. The Soka Gakkai,¹¹ on the other hand, condones the behavior of its members while showing ill-will towards people who are not Soka Gakkai members, or people who oppose SGI. Yet, they claim they follow the teachings of Nichiren Daishonin, which is entirely false. The demeanor of the Soka Gakkai is the opposite of the teachings of Nichiren Daishonin.

9 Ten Worlds - ten conditions of life that are physically and spiritually manifested in a single life. They are: Hell, Hunger, Animality, Anger, Humanity, Heaven (Rapture), Learning, Realization, Bodhisattva, Buddha.

10 Nichiren Daishonin - (1222-1282) the true Buddha who realized the Law of Namumyōhōrengekyō imbedded in the Lotus Sutra and established the Law as the means by which all living beings can become enlightened.

11 Soka Gakkai - SGI – Soka Gakkai International – a lay organization that wrongly incorporates some of the doctrine of Nichiren Shoshu Buddhism into its own philosophy and practice.